

Ashcombe Advisory Partners LLC

www.ashcombeadvisory.com

June 25, 2023

Jennifer Herrera
VP Finance
Suarez-Jones

Dear Ms. Herrera:

This letter records the terms on which our firm will work with Suarez-Jones on the executive messaging we discussed, and it becomes our agreement once you have signed and returned it. We have set it down in plain terms, so that it reads as a fair account of that conversation rather than as a document to be decoded.

Please read it alongside what we talked through. If any line here sits differently from how you understood it, say so before you sign, and we will put it right together.

What We Will Do

We will help Suarez-Jones settle on a clear and steady account of its leadership for the audiences whose reading of the company counts most, and give your executives language they can carry into announcements, briefings, and the ordinary run of investor conversation. Our concern is that what is already true of the company is heard plainly by the people who need to hear it, and that the account holds its shape wherever it is repeated.

In practice this covers the core executive messages and the narrative that frames them, the written materials that carry those messages outward, and our counsel through the moments over the term that will test them. It does not reach into the running of the company or into decisions that are properly yours; where our advice touches those, it stays advice, and the call remains with you.

How We Work

Our method is unhurried and, we hope, plain in feel. We begin by listening, to your leadership and to the people inside and outside the company who already hold a view of it, and we set a small number of core messages down in writing before we build anything on top of them.

From there we prepare the materials that carry those messages and stay close through the moments that put them to work. When circumstances shift over the roughly five months ahead, and they will, we come back to you and adjust the account with you, and not around you.

Because so much of this work lives in correspondence, we keep a clear record of what we send and route anything client-facing through a single point on each side. You will always know what has changed and what is still open, and you will never have to hunt for the current version.

Who Will Do the Work

John Macias will carry the engagement day to day and will be your first point of contact for anything of substance. He does the close work on the drafts and keeps the moving parts legible, and he is the person to bring a question to when it needs a quick answer.

Amy Carter will support the drafting and coordination and keep our correspondence with you in good order, so that where a thread stands is always clear to whoever picks it up next. I will keep a hand on the work myself, particularly on the sensitive announcements, and nothing of weight will leave our office under our name without my having read it. You are welcome to come to me directly at any point, though John Macias will usually be the faster route to an answer.

Fees and Payment

Our fee for the engagement is \$102,000, covering the work described above through its expected close. We will invoice against that amount as the work proceeds, and our invoices are payable within thirty days of receipt.

The fee covers our people and their time. It does not cover out-of-pocket costs such as travel, print production, or third-party services, which we will agree with you before anything of consequence is incurred. Should the shape of the work change materially, we will raise the fee with you and settle it before that work begins.

Term and Notice

The engagement begins July 5, 2023 and is expected to run for about five months. We will treat it as finished when the work is genuinely done rather than when the calendar says so.

Either of us may bring it to a close on fourteen days' written notice. If you end it, you will owe us for work properly completed to that point and for costs already committed on your behalf, and nothing beyond that.

Confidentiality

Everything we learn about Suarez-Jones in the course of the work we will hold in confidence and use only for the engagement. That obligation binds our whole team, survives the end of our work together, and covers the fact of our involvement as much as its substance. We ask the same of you for the methods and materials we share with you.

Limitation of Liability

We will do the work with the care and skill you are entitled to expect, and we stand behind it. We do not, though, control how the press, the markets, or other third parties will finally respond, and so our liability to you under this engagement is limited to the fees paid under it, except where the law does not permit such a limit.

Governing Law

This agreement is governed by the law of the state in which our firm is established, and any dispute under it will be resolved in that state's courts. If any single provision is found unenforceable, the remainder of this letter stands unaffected.

If this reflects our understanding, please sign and return one copy and keep the other for your records. Once it is back with us, John Macias will be in touch to arrange the first conversations, and we can set the kickoff from there. We are glad to be working with the Suarez-Jones team.

Julie Hill

Managing Partner

Date: June 25, 2023

Jennifer Herrera

VP Finance, Suarez-Jones

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